

RowingMod voice recording guide

Effort sounds for the Valheim rowing mod, recorded on an iPhone with Voice Memos.

Phone settings

- 1 **Settings > Apps > Voice Memos > Audio Quality > Lossless.** This avoids compression.
- 2 **Leave "Enhance Recording" off.** It can smear short sounds; noise gets cleaned up afterwards.

Room

- 3 **Pick a quiet room:** away from fans, the fridge, the washing machine and traffic.
- 4 **Prefer soft furnishings:** a bedroom or a living room with a sofa and curtains. Avoid tiled bathrooms and kitchens, which echo.

Mic position

- 5 **Hold the phone 20-30 cm from your mouth.** Too close distorts and picks up spit; too far picks up the room.
- 6 **Aim slightly to the side** of your mouth, not straight at it, so breath pops don't hit the mic.
- 7 **Keep the phone still:** rest it on something rather than holding it, since handling noise shows up on recordings.

Performance

- 8 **Really make the effort:** pull on a towel, push against a doorframe, or lift something heavy while you grunt. Acted grunts sound fake.
- 9 **Vary every take:** change the vowel ("hnh", "hup", "uhh", "hah"), the length and the strength. Variety matters more than perfection.
- 10 **Leave about 1 second of silence between takes,** so they can be split automatically.
- 11 **One memo per sound type,** named as in the list on the next page.
- 12 **For breathing, do real exercise first** (jumping jacks, stairs), then record yourself catching your breath.
- 13 **Record more than you need.** Bad takes get thrown out, and spares add variety.

Sending

- 14 **AirDrop the memos to the Mac** (they land in Downloads) and say the file names.

What to record

One memo per row. Record a set per voice: male, and female if someone can help. Tick each memo off when it's done.

Needed

#	Memo name	When the game plays it	What it sounds like	Length	Takes	Done
1	grunt-light	Normal strong strokes	Short, controlled effort: pulling something moderately heavy	0.2-0.6 s	15-20	☐
2	grunt-hard	Strokes under heavy load: headwind, crew pushing hard	Full-effort pull, as if hauling an oar against the wind	0.3-0.8 s	15-20	☐
3	brake	The blade digging in when you start braking	A strained, held "nnngh", bracing against something pulling away	0.5-1.0 s	8-10	☐

Nice to have

#	Memo name	When the game plays it	What it sounds like	Length	Takes	Done
4	breathing	Between strokes when stamina is low	Real panting: do jumping jacks first, then just breathe	30-60 s in one go	1	☐
5	tired	Running out of stamina ("Too tired to row")	An exhausted groan or sigh	0.5-1.5 s	5-8	☐
6	clash	Your stroke clashes with the crew's rhythm	A short annoyed grunt or "tch", oar jarring in your hands	0.2-0.5 s	5-8	☐

Ideas for later (not planned yet)

#	Memo name	When the game plays it	What it sounds like	Length	Takes	Done
7	calls	The beat, when the crew is in sync	A rhythm call: "Row!", "Heave!", "Pull!" in a Norse-ish voice	0.3-1.0 s	5-10	☐
8	crew-sync	Several rowers hitting the same beat	A shared, punchy "hup!"	0.2-0.5 s	8-10	☐

Every take is cleaned (trimmed, denoised, levelled, EQ'd), varied in pitch, and auditioned in game (N / B / L) before anything goes into the mod.